ROBERT H. SMITH SCHOOL OF BUSINESS
CENTER FOR SOCIAL VALUE CREATION

hack4impact-UMD

Claude | Builder Club @ Maryland

BUILDFEST

BUSINESS IMPACT CHALLENGE SERIES

Hosted by the Center for Social Value Creation and
Hack4Impact at the Robert H. Smith School of Business

NONPROFIT DATA CHALLENGE

2026

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CHALLENGE INFORMATION

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the inaugural University of Maryland BuildFest challenge! The challenge is supported by the Center for Social Value Creation (CSVC) at the Robert H. Smith School of Business, EveryMind, Hack4Impact-UMD, and Claude Builder Club .

This brief includes the case scenario as well as a summary of the case structure and rules. The case is based on a real organization, with preliminary data provided to conduct initial research.

CSVC+HACK4IMPACT

Grounded in the Center for Social Value Creation's focus on responsible, long-term value creation and developed in partnership with Hack4Impact, this competition challenges students to leverage data analytics and AI tools to help nonprofits address real-world challenges, improve organizational effectiveness, and create meaningful social impact.

Participants are expected to apply rigorous data analysis alongside a social impact lens, using data-driven insights and responsible AI to help nonprofits understand community needs, improve program effectiveness, and develop actionable solutions that better serve their communities.

TIMELINE

Sunday, November 1st (9AM)
Case released

Monday, November 2nd (7PM)
Workshop hosted by Claude Builder Club & Dr. Fardina Alam
(all participants must attend)

Thursday, November 5th (6PM)
Optional office hours

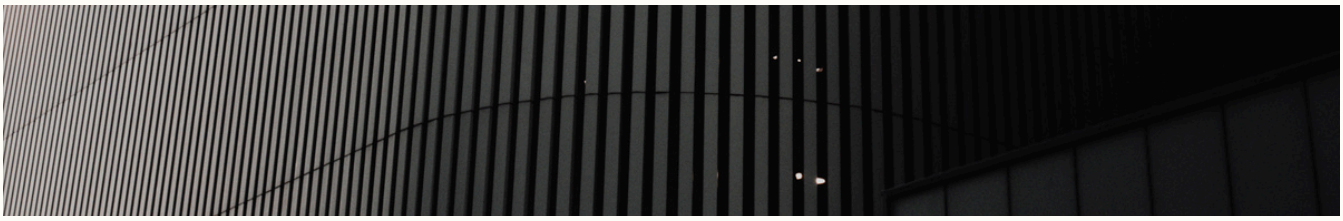
Sunday, November 8th (9AM)
All deliverables due

Friday November 13th (9AM)
Finalists announced

Monday, November 16th (11PM)
All final presentation updates due

Tuesday, November 17th (5:30-9PM)
VMH 2517
Finals for top 5 teams + Networking Dinner (**RSVP to attend**)

CHALLENGE INFORMATION CONT.



General Information

Judges will be industry professionals, along with a representative from EveryMind, who will independently evaluate first-round submissions.

The five selected finalist teams will receive instructions on next steps and present in person at Van Munching Hall. All competition updates will be communicated via email at kupaumd1@umd.edu.

First Round

All teams must submit the required deliverables. Teams advancing to Finals will be notified on Friday, November 13, with further instructions for their presentations.

Finals Round

Finals and Awards: The top five teams by overall score present live at Finals on Tuesday, November 17, with a 10-minute presentation and Q&A. **First and second place** receive prizes. Three track awards also recognize standout work from any team, whether or not it reaches Finals. These are: **Best Technical Tool, Most Effective Visualization, and EveryMind's Choice**. All award winners will be recognized at the Finals evening.

INTRODUCTION TO AI + DATA

HOW CAN AI AND DATA SUPPORT NONPROFITS AND THEIR COMMUNITIES?

Data analytics helps nonprofits transform information into actionable insights that improve decision-making, evaluate program effectiveness, and identify community needs. Artificial intelligence (AI) can enhance this process by assisting with data preparation, identifying patterns, automating tasks, and communicating findings. Together, AI and data analytics can help nonprofits make better use of limited resources, strengthen their programs, and better serve the communities they support.

AI + DATA IN NONPROFITS

Nonprofits are increasingly exploring how AI and data analytics can improve both operational efficiency and organizational effectiveness. These technologies offer opportunities across several key areas:

Operational Efficiency: Automating routine tasks, organizing information, and streamlining administrative processes to allow staff to focus more on their missions.

Program Evaluation & Insights: Analyzing surveys, participant feedback, and program outcomes to measure effectiveness, identify gaps, and guide improvements.

Community Needs & Resource Allocation: Identifying trends across populations, understanding underserved communities, and using data to inform where resources and support are most needed.

Responsible AI & Data Use: Ensuring accuracy, transparency, privacy, and fairness when using AI and data to support decisions that affect communities.

AI + DATA CONT.

How do AI + Data Firms Work?

Nonprofits collect information through surveys, programs, and community engagement to better understand the populations they serve. By combining data analytics with AI tools, organizations can identify trends, evaluate program effectiveness, streamline operations, and translate findings into actionable recommendations that support their missions.

Target

1. Identify Opportunities: use data to uncover community needs, service gaps, and areas for program improvement.
2. Support Findings with Data: apply analytical methods and AI tools to identify patterns, evaluate outcomes, and develop evidence-based insights.
3. Drive Better Decisions: translate findings into practical recommendations that help nonprofits allocate resources, strengthen programs, and better serve their communities.



CASE BRIEF

SITUATION OVERVIEW

You are a Data + Analytics associate supporting EveryMind, a nonprofit dedicated to strengthening communities and empowering individuals to reach optimal mental wellness. Through direct services, advocacy, and community partnerships, EveryMind works to expand access to mental health support and resources.

Among its services, EveryMind offers 988 awareness training to help communities recognize mental health crises and access support. Post-training surveys assess participants' knowledge, experiences, and training effectiveness across populations.

Your objective is to analyze this feedback and develop actionable insights that evaluate training effectiveness, identify knowledge and behavioral-intent gaps, examine differences across participant groups, and and develop recommendations for the future.



BUSINESS QUESTION

How can EveryMind use its 988 training feedback data to develop an actionable solution for evaluating training effectiveness, identifying gaps across communities, and continuously improving future trainings?

SUPPORTING QUESTIONS

These questions are optional starting points; you may explore others.

1. How can EveryMind better evaluate training effectiveness, identify meaningful patterns in participant responses, and monitor outcomes over time?
2. What trends, relationships, or differences in the survey data provide insights into participants' training experiences and outcomes?
3. How do training experiences and outcomes differ across communities and participant populations, and what might these differences reveal about opportunities to improve accessibility, equity, and community impact?

KEY DATA: EVERYMIND

This section provides background on EveryMind's programs, 988 awareness training, and the survey data available for analysis. Use this information to understand the organization's work and connect your findings to practical decisions. This context will help you identify opportunities for improvement and develop recommendations that align with EveryMind's mission and community needs.



EVERYMIND OVERVIEW

WHAT DOES EVERYMIND DO?

Founded in 1957, EveryMind is a nonprofit dedicated to strengthening communities and promoting mental wellness. Through counseling, crisis support, education, and outreach, EveryMind works to improve access to mental health resources, reduce stigma, and empower individuals and families to lead healthier lives.

COMMUNITY EDUCATION

EveryMind offers educational programs that equip individuals with practical skills to recognize and respond to mental health challenges. These include Mental Health First Aid, Question, Persuade, Refer (QPR), and 988 awareness training.

988 AWARENESS TRAINING

EveryMind's 988 awareness training focuses on helping participants recognize mental health challenges and crises, understand how the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline works, and know when to seek support for themselves or others. The training aims to strengthen awareness and confidence in accessing mental health resources.

WHY YOUR WORK MATTERS

Your team will help EveryMind turn this feedback into actionable insights. By identifying strengths, differences across participant groups, and opportunities for improvement, your analysis can guide decisions about training content, delivery, and accessibility. These insights are also used to support grant applications, funding decisions, and program reporting.

YOUR TASK

YOUR CHALLENGE IS TO USE DATA ANALYTICS AND AI TOOLS TO TURN EVERYMIND'S 988 TRAINING FEEDBACK DATA INTO ACTIONABLE INSIGHTS AND RECOMMENDATIONS.

STEPS

1. Make a copy of the dataset and begin exploring! Identify key variables, examine survey responses, and understand the scope and limitations of the data.

2. Clean and prepare the dataset by addressing missing values, inconsistencies, and formatting issues to ensure accurate and reliable analysis.

3. Analyze the data to identify meaningful trends, changes in knowledge, behavioral intent, and differences in training outcomes across participant groups.

4. Consider incorporating AI tools throughout your workflow to assist with data preparation, analysis, coding, or visualization. Validate AI-generated outputs and document how AI was used.

5. Develop a functional technical artifact, such as a script, notebook, dashboard, or application, that transforms your analysis into clear, accessible, and usable insights.

6. Translate your findings into specific, evidence-based recommendations that address identified gaps and help EveryMind improve future training effectiveness and community outcomes.



DELIVERABLE REQUIREMENTS

ALL SUBMISSIONS MUST INCLUDE THE FIVE REQUIRED DELIVERABLES.

Technical Artifact

Develop a working script, notebook, dashboard, application, or automated pipeline that transforms survey data into usable insights.

- Must run without errors and accurately process the provided dataset.
- Must produce clear, usable outputs and support reasonable data updates.
- Include instructions for running or accessing the solution.
- Include a video demonstration of no more than 2 minutes (120 sec) showcasing the artifact and its functionality.

Process Memo

Submit a 1-2 page memo explaining your approach, findings, and recommendations for a nontechnical audience

- Key Findings: Summarize the most important insights.
- Methodology: Explain how the data was prepared and analyzed.
- Recommendations: Propose actionable improvements
- Implementation: Briefly explain how EveryMind staff would use your solution on future surveys: who would run it, how often, and what they would need.
- Limitations: Acknowledge relevant data and analytical constraints.

DELIVERABLE REQUIREMENTS CONT.

ALL SUBMISSIONS MUST INCLUDE THE FIVE REQUIRED DELIVERABLES.

AI Process Appendix

1 page document describing how AI tools contributed to your workflow and how their outputs were validated.

- Identify AI tools used and provide representative prompts.
- Explain how AI outputs were refined or improved.
- Describe at least one AI error, limitation, or unsuccessful result encountered.
- Explain what was independently verified, corrected, or completed manually.
- Demonstrate how final findings were validated against the data.

Presentation

All teams must prepare a draft presentation submitted in .pptx format, highlighting their technical solution, key findings, AI integration, and actionable recommendations. If selected as a Top 5 Finalist, teams will have the opportunity to update it by Monday, November 16th.

SUBMISSION REQ.

SUBMISSION DEADLINE: ***SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 8, 2026 AT 9:00 AM (ET)***
EACH TEAM MUST SUBMIT ONE COMPLETE ENTRY THROUGH THE OFFICIAL BUILDFEST SUBMISSION FORM.

What to Submit

Submit one complete entry per team through the official BuildFest Submission Form. Each team must submit the following five required deliverables: Technical Artifact, Video Demonstration, Process Memo, AI Process Appendix, and Presentation by the deadline. Late submissions will not be accepted.

File Format

All files must follow the "Team#_Deliverable" naming format + the exact extension. Replace "#" with your assigned team number. Follow the examples below, replacing "12" with your assigned team number. *Do not include personal names, university identifiers, or additional text in filenames.

All deliverables must use the file formats and extensions shown in the examples to the right. The Technical Artifact and Demo can be submitted as any executable file/link.

EXAMPLES

- Team12_Memo.pdf
- Team12_AIAppendix.pdf
- Team12_Presentation.pptx
- Team12_Demo.mp4
- Team12_TechnicalArtifact

Additional Requirements

Judging is anonymous. Remove all identifying information from submitted deliverables. Ensure that linked resources do not reveal team member identities.

All submitted links must be set to 'Anyone with the link' can view. Verify that judges can access each file or resource without requesting permission. Technical artifacts must include clear run or access instructions.

JUDGING CRITERIA

JUDGES ARE INTERESTED IN HOW EFFECTIVELY TEAMS USE DATA ANALYTICS AND AI TO DEVELOP ACCURATE, MEANINGFUL INSIGHTS AND ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATIONS.

Functionality & Correctness	• Accurately analyzes and represents the provided dataset. • Produces correct calculations, findings, and visualizations. • Delivers a functional solution with clear, usable outputs.
Technical Soundness	• Applies appropriate analytical methods and tools to address the research questions. • Demonstrates a well-structured, reproducible analysis with justified methods and acknowledged limitations.
Business Impact & Social Impact	• Connects findings to EveryMind's training goals and community needs. • Provides actionable, evidence-based, and socially responsible recommendations. • Identifies meaningful gaps or differences across participant groups, where supported by the data.
AI Process & Transparency	• Clearly documents AI tools, their purposes, and how they were used. • Independently validates AI-generated outputs for accuracy and reliability. • Acknowledges potential biases, limitations, and ethical considerations.

JUDGING RUBRIC

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Developing
Functionality & Correctness 20%	Fully functional artifact; accurate survey calculations, visualizations, and outputs; runs from instructions and handles data updates	Functional artifact with accurate findings and minor errors or update limitations.	Partially functional artifact with calculation errors or unclear outputs.	Major errors, incorrect findings, or a nonfunctional solution.
Technical Soundness 30%	Well-justified, reproducible methods; reports sample sizes, handles small groups and data inconsistencies, analyzes open-ended comments, and addresses limits such as retrospective ratings.	Sound methods and reproducible analysis with minor documentation or methodological gaps.	Basic analysis with limited cleaning, documentation, or consideration of data limitations.	Flawed methods, inadequate data preparation, or unsupported conclusions.
Business & Social Impact 35%	Identifies meaningful training gaps, prioritized recommendations with feasible implementation and impact measures; flags thin findings and protects privacy.	Identifies relevant training trends and provides actionable recommendations with limited implementation detail.	Describes general survey trends with vague recommendations or limited community relevance.	Findings lack evidence, with no clear recommendations for improving training or community outcomes.
AI Process & Transparency 15%	Documents AI tools, prompts, revisions, and errors; independently verifies outputs against the data.	Documents AI usage and demonstrates reasonable validation with minor gaps.	Lists AI tools but provides limited prompts, revisions, or validation evidence.	AI usage is unclear or undocumented; outputs are unverified.

TRACKS

ALL TEAMS ARE ELIGIBLE FOR TRACK AWARDS, REGARDLESS OF FINALIST STATUS. WINNERS ARE DETERMINED USING THE RELEVANT JUDGING CRITERIA

Best Technical Tool	Recognizes the team with the strongest technical solution, based on the combined Functionality & Correctness and Technical Soundness scores. The award emphasizes reliability, appropriate analytical methods, reproducibility, and usability.
Most Effective Visualization	Recognizes the team whose visualizations most clearly and effectively communicate meaningful insights. Judges evaluate visual clarity, accuracy, usefulness, and the ability to make findings accessible to a nontechnical audience.
EveryMind's Choice	Selected by EveryMind from the top eight teams in Business & Social Impact. This award emphasizes practical value to EveryMind, including meaningful community impact, equitable access, and actionable improvements to its training programs.

RESOURCES

THE FOLLOWING ARE SOME ADDITIONAL RESOURCES YOU CAN USE TO CREATE YOUR ANALYSIS, TECHNICAL ARTIFACT, AND DELIVERABLES

1. Data Cleaning & Analysis
   - Getting started with Pandas
   - Pandas - Cleaning Data
   - Pandas User Guide
   - Google Colab / Jupyter Notebook
   - Kaggle - Data Cleaning
2. Tutorials for developing dashboards and presenting visuals
   - Microsoft Power BI Learning Resources
   - Matplotlib
   - Kaggle - Data Visualization
3. Deliverables
   - Citing AI Generated Content
   - Memo Template

GOOD LUCK!